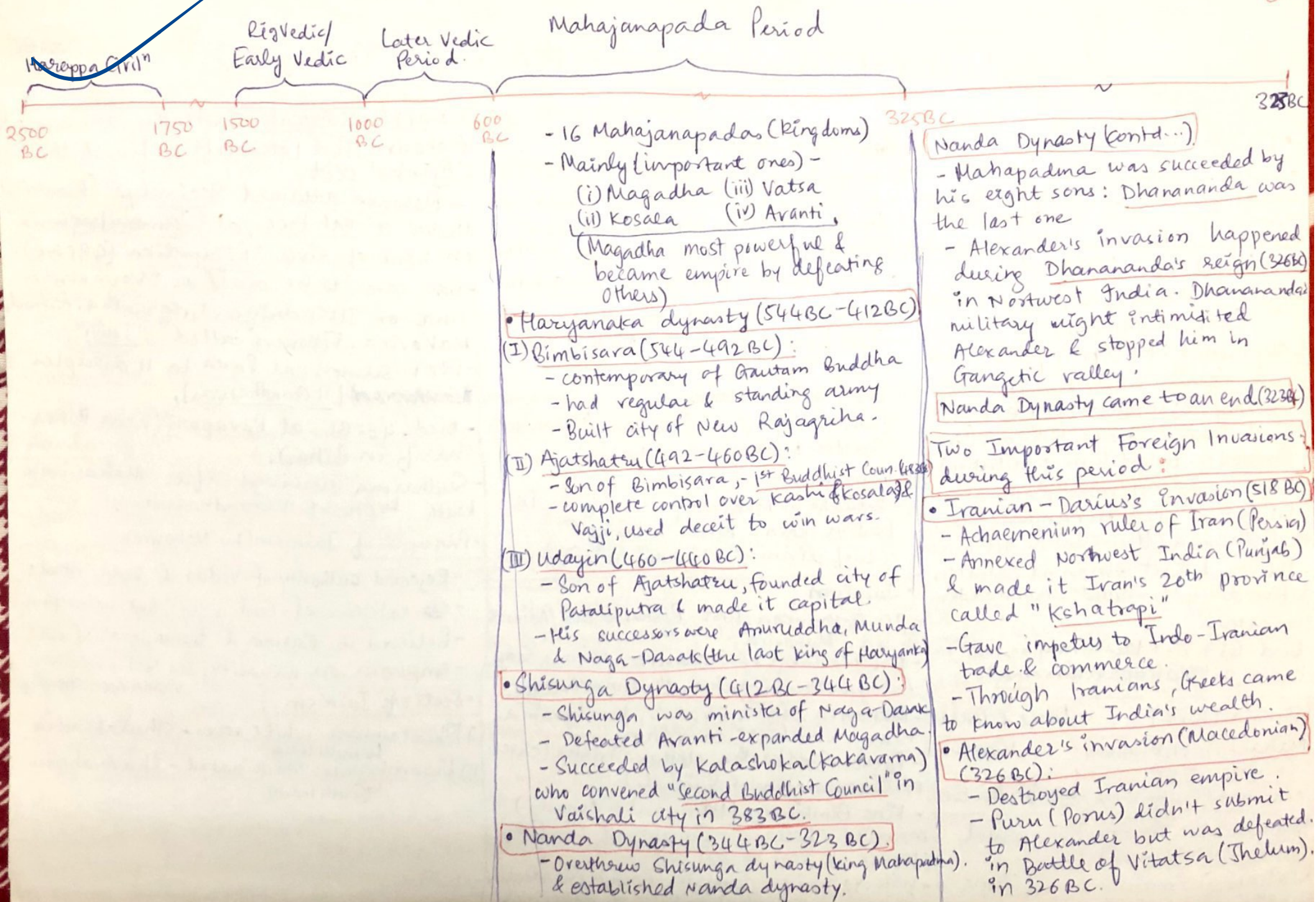




Period of Religious Reforms (6th Century - 4th Century BC)

400 BC

600 BC

Buddhism

- Buddha born in 563 BC at Lumbinivana in Sakya Kshatriya clan (Kosala Kingdom)
 (Kosala Kingdom)
- Father: Siddhodhana (King of Kapilvastu) (Republican King)
- Mother: Mahamaya (Princess of Koliya) (Republican empire)
- Stepmother: Mahaprajapati Gautami
- Wife: Yasodhara (Shakya Princess)
- Son: Rahul; Renounced home @ 29.
- First Teacher: Alara Kalama (Sannyasi Philosopher - taught him meditation)
- Next Teacher: Udraka Ramputra
- On bank of river Niranjana (Falgu), in Bodhi Gaya (Bihar) he got Nirvana
- Delivered first sermon at Sarnath, to five disciples ~ called "Dhammacakkha Pravartana"
 (Magadha Kingdom)
- Died: 483 BC - Kushinagar (UP) ~ known as "Mahaparinirvana"

Tanma (Birth)	Lotus & Bull
Mahabhinishkramana (Renunciation)	Horse
Nirvana (Enlightenment)	Bodhi tree
Dhammacakkha Pravartana (First sermon)	Wheel
Mahaparinirvana (Death)	Stupa

Sects of Buddhism:

- (I) Hinayana / Theravada *(more respectful term)*
 - No idol-worship, Pali language, Prevailed in South of India (Sri Lanka, Burma, Thailand, Java, etc.) *(older than Mahayana)*
 - Two subsects: Vaibhasika; Sautantika
- (II) Mahayana: Belief in 'Bodhisattvas'
 - Idol worship, Sanskrit, North of India - China, Japan, Korea
 - Two subsects: Madhyamika or Shunyavada (founder: Nagarjuna); Yogachara / Vijnanavada (founder: Maitreyanatha & Asanga)
- (III) Vajrayana:
 - Believed in magical power (Vajra), in Eastern India: Bihar & Bengal
 - Chief divinity: "Tara" - (Goddess)

Jainism

- 24 Tirthankars: first: Rishabhadeva / Adinath & last: Mahavira *(first four by Parshwanath 63rd Tr.)*
- Five teachings of Mahavira: Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Aparigraha, Brahmacharya
- Mahavira: Born 540 BC, Kundagrama near Vaishali in Bihar. *(Lichhavi prince)*
- Father: Siddhartha, Mother: Trisha (sister of Chetaka - king of Vaishali). *(Vajji Sangha)*
- King Bimbisara (Magadha dynasty) married Chellana - daughter of Chetaka. *(He did not like her)*
- wife: Yasoda, daughter: Anonja Priyadarshini
- Son-in-law: Jamali (first disciple of Mahavira)

'Way of the elders'

- Makkhali Gosala initially accompanied Mahavira, but later left & found the "Ajinka" sect.
- Mahavira attained "Kaivalya" (knowledge) under a sal tree, at "Jambhikagrama" on bank of river "Rijupalika" (498 BC).
- Now came to be called as "Kavalin" or Jina or Jitendraiya, Nrigrantha, Arhant Mahavira. Followers called: "Jain".
- First sermon: at Pava to 11 disciples ~~Mahavira~~ [11 Gandharvas],
- Died: 468 BC, at Parapuri (near Bihar Sharif in Bihar).
- Sudharma survived after Mahavira's death. *(One of 11 Gandharvas)*

Principles of Jainism (by Mahavira):

- Rejected authority of Vedas & Vedic rituals
- existence of God → Yes! But below Jina.
- Believed in Karma & transmigran of soul
- emphasis on equality, did NOT condemn varna sys. strongly

Sects of Jainism:

- (I) Shwetambars: white robes - Shulabhadra
 (North India)
- (II) Digambaras: stark naked - Bhadrabahu
 (South India)

600BC 325BC 322BC

298BC 273BC

232BC

185BC

Chandragupta Mauveya

- Defeated Nanda ruler Dhananand & occupied Pataliputra in 322BC

- 305BC: Defeated Seleus Nikator who surrendered vast territories in the west.

- "Megasthenes" - Greek ambassador in Chandragupta Mauveya's court.

- Followed Jainism, went to Sravanbelgola in Karnataka & died there of slow starvation (Kaya Klesha (Salekham)).

- Trade flourished, weights & measures were standardised, money came into use.

298-273BC Bindusara

- son of Chandragupta Mauveya

- known to Greeks as "Amitrochates"

- Patronised "Ajivika" → "Barabar caves" were built

Features of Mauveyan Empire

- Centralised administration. ✓

- Revenue collection, civil & criminal courts.

- Provincial administration [5 provinces].

- Municipal administration. (1) - North (Taxila)

↳ to maintain law & order (2) - West (Ujjain)

- Huge army & navy. ✓

- Existence of Detectives & spies.

- State controlled economy, irrigation facility, water tax.

(3) - East & Central (Patala)

(4) - Kalinga (East) (Toshali)

(5) - South (Surarnagiri)

Ashoka

- Buddhist tradition says Ashoka killed his 99 brothers to take the throne.

- Self-coronated in 269BC

- Whole of subcontinent except for extreme south was under Mauveya empire. [first time all of India under one rule!].

- Kalinga war: 261BC

- Ashoka was moved by the bloodshed & decided to abandon war & followed a policy of cultural conquest.

- Ashoka sent missionaries to Cholas & Pandyas and five Greek kings; and to Sri Lanka and Burma & Southeast Asia.

- Toll taxes ✓

- Important ports: Bharukachch (Bharuch) and Sapara on western coast;

Tamralipti in Bengal on Eastern coast.

- punch marked coins (mostly silver)

- High position of women & freedom. ✓

- Women permitted to have divorce or remarriage. ✓

Later Mauveyas

Ashoka death

↓
division of kingdom into East & West.

↓
Dasaratha

↓
Kunala

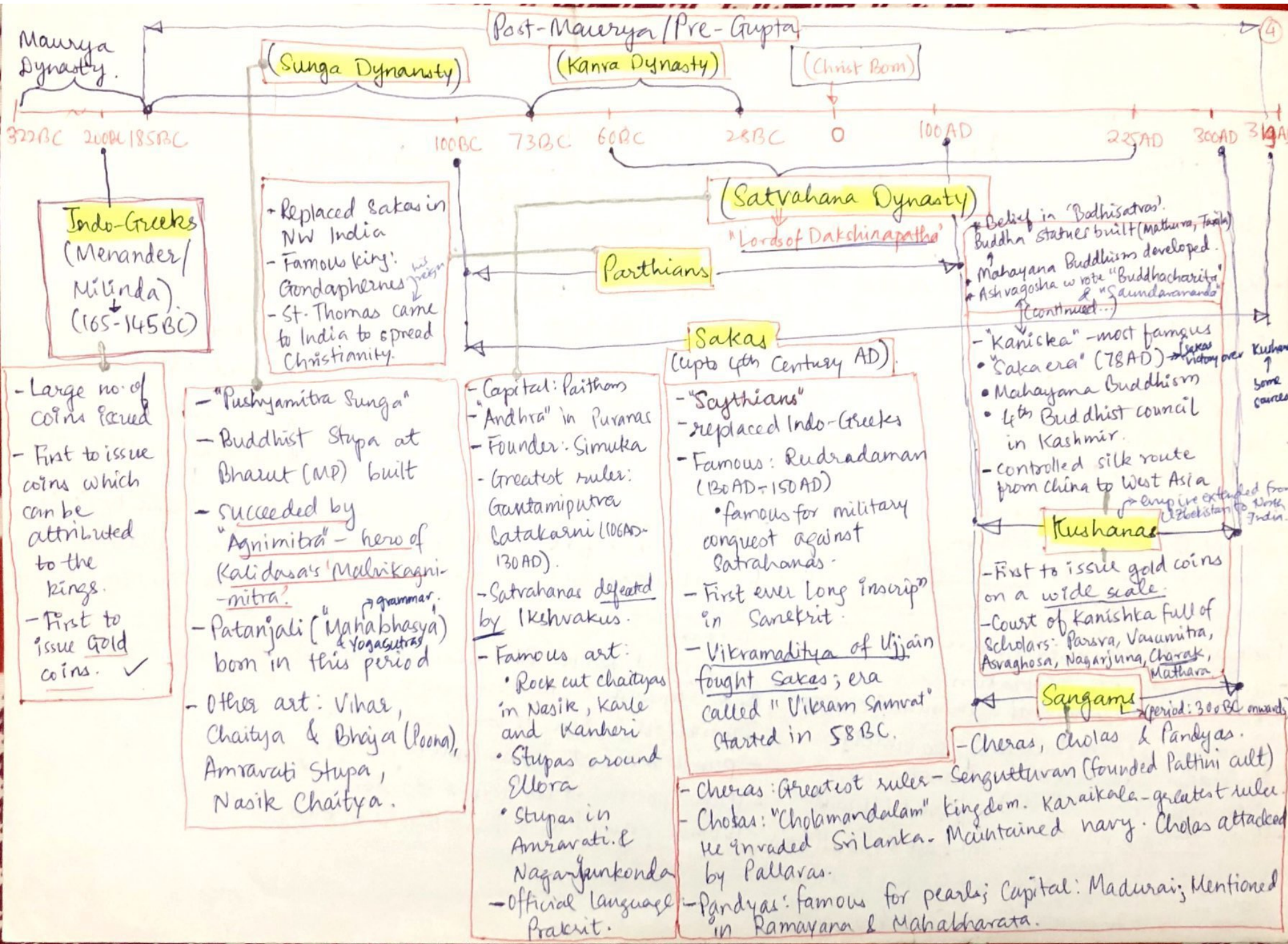
- Last Mauveyan king: Brihadratha.

↓
assassinated by his Chief commander "Sunga"

↓
Sunga Dynasty (185BC)

(Capital: Vidisha (MP)).

Full Name: "Pushyamitra Sunga"



(Gupta Dynasty)

319 AD

334 AD

380 AD

414 AD

455 AD

467 AD

540 AD

(Chandragupta I)

- "Maharajadhiraja".
- Matrimonial alliances with Licchavis of Mithila.
- Magadha, Prayaga & Saket.
- Original type of Gold coins (Dinaras) - Chandragupta I and Kumaradevi type.

Do:

Gupta Art, Architecture, Administration, social conditions (esp. plight of women), de-centralisation of power, etc. from the book. [very imp. for Gupta period].

(Samudragupta)

(his mother was a Licchavi princess)

- Greatest king
- Inscriptions: Prayaga Prasasti / Allahabad stone inscription.
- Called "Napoleon of India" by V.A. Smith.
- Dominion over Java, Sumatra and Malaya islands.
- Titles: Kariraja, Param Bhagavat, Vikram, Sarva-raj - Ochchhetra.
- Types of gold coins - Gashed type, Dhanurdhari, Axe type, Ashvamedha type, Vyagraha-nan type, Tiger killing type, Veeravahan type, etc.
- "Vaishnavite".
- Megharasha, king of Sri Lanka sent embassy to Samudragupta to seek permission to build a monastery for Buddhist pilgrims at Bodhi Gaya.
- Harisena - poet in court of Samudragupta - composed "Prashasti" in praise of.

Chandragupta II

- Also called "Vikramaditya".
- Succeeded Ramagupta who ruled for a very short period.
- Matrimonial alliances with Nagas & Vakatakas.
- Overthrew Saka rulers in west India.
- First to issue "silver" coins.
- "Navratna" in court: Famous ones - Kalidasa, Dhanvanti, Asvabhata.

Gold coins types: Ashvavahi, Chhatradhari, Chakra-Vikram, etc.

← Fa Hsein (Fa Xian) visited India ↓

(talks about plight of untouchables)

- inscription on pillar near Qutub Minar

Kumargupta I

- threatened by Huns.
- worshipper of Kartikeya
- Founded Nalanda Mahavihara.
- Gold coins: Khadgadhari, Gajavahi, Khag-Nihanta, Rhino-slayer, Kartikeya, Apratigh-mudra types.

Skandagupta

- last great ruler.
- Invaded by Huns.

Gupta coins were not as pure as Kushan's but were many in number types.

check!

Mehrauli

(Post Gupta / Vardhana Dynasty)

6

550 AD

- Founder: Pushyabhuti ("Vardhana")
- First imp ruler: Prabhakara-vardhana. (580-605 AD)
- Rajyavardhana took over (605-606 AD)
- Harshavardhana (606-647 AD).
- "Banabhatta" Harshacharita (in Sanskrit) → famous work.

"Harshavardhana":

- also called "Siladitya"
- 606 AD: "Harsha" era.
- Capital: Kannauj.
- "Hiuen Tsang" (Chinese pilgrim) visited India in dominions of Harsha. *also spelt as: Xuan Zang.*
- Hiuen Tsang's reports mention about "Kannauj assembly" &

Another Chinese Pilgrim: I. Ching 50 yrs after H.T.

"Prayaga Assembly".

647 AD

- Prayaga Assembly - possibly beginning of Kumbha Mela.
- "Shairite".
- Nalanda university maintained by Harsha. *(H.T. studied here)*
- Harsha - an accomplished writer - wrote Nagananda, Ratnavali & Priyadarshika.

Chalukya of Badami

543 AD

575 AD

755 AD

897 AD

Pallavas

- In South India, Vakatakas were followed by Chalukyas.
- Pulakesin ~~III~~ ^(II) was able to contain Harshavardhan in Deccan.
- "Aihole inscription".
- Hiuen Tsang visited Pulakesin ~~III~~ ^(II) also.
- Pallava ruler Narsimharasman.
- 'Mamalla' overthrew Chalukyas.
- Chalukyas completely destroyed by Rashtrakutas in 757 AD.

- Orthodox Brahminical Hindus.
- Capital at Kandipuram.
- Struggle with Chalukyas for supremacy over Krishna & Tungabhadra (land betn them).
- spread Indian culture to SE Asia.
- Pallava temple style got famous - "Dravidian" style.

- Pallava sculpture - largely Buddhist tradition.
- Best example: "Descent of Ganges" or the "Arjuna's Penance" at Mammallapuram.
- destroyed by Rashtrakutas & Chola dynasties. *later Cholas* *diffnt from Sangam Cholas* *No! check!*